

Data-Driven Visualizations for Monroe County Childhood Conditions Summit

The following is a comprehensive list of 50 proposed visualizations, organized by thematic category, to illuminate the past decade of childhood conditions in Monroe County, Indiana. Each visualization idea includes the recommended format, the official data source(s) to use, guidance on data preparation, and a description of its impact and usefulness for the summit. These visuals align with the summit's theme that “**what surrounds us, shapes us**”, emphasizing safe, stable, and nurturing relationships and environments (SSNREs) ¹.

Demographics of Monroe County Youth (Visualizations 1–5)

- 1. Child Population Trend (Line Chart)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census/ACS via Stats Indiana. Extract the number of children under 18 in Monroe County for each year (or key years like 2010, 2015, 2020, 2025) from census estimates. Clean by compiling a time series of the under-18 population. *Visualization:* A line chart showing Monroe County's child population over the last 10 years. *Impact:* Reveals whether the youth population is growing, shrinking, or stable. For example, Monroe County had about **21,600 children in 2024** ², only ~15% of the total population (much lower than ~23% statewide) ². This context is helpful for planning – a flat or declining child population might signal challenges for sustaining schools and services, while growth could indicate increasing needs. *Summit Usefulness:* Sets the stage by quantifying the youth population that community efforts are serving and how that baseline has changed over a decade.
- 2. Age Distribution Pyramid (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* American Community Survey 5-Year Estimates ². Obtain population counts by age groups (0–4, 5–17, 18–24, etc.) for Monroe County. Clean by focusing on child and young adult categories and calculating percentages. *Visualization:* A population pyramid or side-by-side bar chart comparing Monroe County's age structure to Indiana's. *Impact:* Highlights Monroe County's unique age profile. For instance, **only ~15.4% of Monroe's residents are under 18**, compared to ~22.9% statewide ². Meanwhile, the county has a large college-age cohort (18–24). This reflects how the university presence “surrounds” local youth. *Summit Usefulness:* Emphasizes that children are a smaller slice of the community here, which may affect resource allocation and the social environment. It underlines the need for intentional focus on youth so they aren't overlooked in a college-town demographic.
- 3. Racial/Ethnic Composition of Children (Pie or Stacked Bar)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census Bureau (ACS demographics by age/race) ³ ⁴. Pull data on the racial and ethnic breakdown of Monroe County's under-18 population (or use overall population as a proxy if child-specific data is limited). Clean by isolating key groups (White, Black, Hispanic, Asian, multiracial, etc.) and calculating percentages. *Visualization:* A pie chart or stacked bar showing the proportions of children by race/ethnicity. *Impact:* Shows diversity or lack thereof among youth. For example, Monroe County's overall population is **about 84.6% White, 4.1% Black, 7.7% Asian, 3.1% multiracial, and 5.1% Hispanic (any race)** ⁵. The chart can focus on the youth subset, which likely has similar makeup. *Summit Usefulness:* Helps

stakeholders consider equity and inclusion. If certain groups are small in number, it reminds the community to ensure those children still feel a sense of belonging. If diversity is growing among the youth, it highlights the importance of culturally responsive practices in schools and services.

4. **Geographic Distribution of Child Poverty (Heat Map)** – *Data Source:* American Community Survey (e.g. ACS 5-year data at census tract level) and Monroe County GIS data. Download tract-level poverty rates or counts for children. Clean by mapping each tract's data and merging with a county map shape file. *Visualization:* A color-coded map of Monroe County (down to neighborhoods or tracts) showing **child poverty rates** in each area. *Impact:* Exposes spatial inequalities – pockets where children experience higher poverty. For instance, a map might show higher poverty in certain Bloomington neighborhoods or rural townships. In the ACS, Monroe County's overall child poverty was **14% in 2024** (down from ~20% in 2014) ⁶, but the map could reveal if specific areas exceed that. *Summit Usefulness:* Ties directly to “the neighborhoods they live in”. This visualization provokes discussion on place-based strategies – e.g. targeting resources to high-need neighborhoods or learning why some areas have thrived. It leverages the power of spatial data (echoing the summit's GIS session) to engage audiences with local insights.
5. **Birth Rate and Trends (Line or Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana State Department of Health Vital Statistics ⁷. Gather the number of live births in Monroe County each year for the past decade. Clean by tabulating yearly totals and computing the birth rate per 1,000 population. *Visualization:* A line graph of annual births or birth rates from 2013 to 2022. *Impact:* Acts as a leading indicator of future youth population. In 2021 Monroe County saw **1,105 births**, including **49 births to teen mothers** ⁷. Over 10 years, the trend could show a decline (reflecting statewide decreases in birth rates and teen pregnancies) or fluctuations. *Summit Usefulness:* If births have dropped, it might indicate fewer incoming kindergarteners and possibly smaller class sizes ahead – or it could reflect positive outcomes like fewer teen pregnancies. This can spark conversation about supporting maternal/infant health and anticipating shifts in demand for early childhood services.

Family & Community Environment (Visualizations 6–15)

1. **Household Types of Families with Children (Clustered Bar)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census Bureau (ACS Table S1101) ⁸. Retrieve data on household composition, specifically counts of **married-couple households with children** and **single-parent households** in Monroe County. Clean by calculating the share of all family households that each category represents. *Visualization:* A clustered bar chart comparing Monroe County vs Indiana: e.g., percent of family households that are two-parent vs single-parent. *Impact:* Quantifies family structure stability. Monroe County has **3,588 single-parent households (6.2% of all households)** ⁹, which is a lower proportion than the state average (8.9%). When looking only at households with children, about **32% are single-parent in Monroe** ¹⁰ (vs roughly 35–40% in Indiana). This suggests relatively more children in two-parent settings locally. *Summit Usefulness:* Connects to the “relationships” that shape youth. Fewer single-parent families might mean relatively less economic strain on average, but for the 3,500+ single-parent families, community support is crucial. The visualization underscores successes (Monroe outperforming state average) and remaining needs (supporting single parents and their kids) to maintain **stable, nurturing home environments**.
2. **Trend in Single-Parent Household Rate (Line Chart)** – *Data Source:* ACS 5-year estimates via FRED (Federal Reserve Economic Data) ¹⁰. Use the yearly percentage of households with children that are

single-parent for Monroe County. Clean by pulling a decade of values (note: ACS 5-year data overlaps, so focus on overall direction rather than tiny year-to-year changes). *Visualization:* A line chart from ~2013 to 2023 of Monroe County's single-parent household percentage. *Impact:* Shows changes in family structure over time. In **2020**, the share spiked to 35% but has since **declined to about 31.8% in 2023** ¹⁰. This decline could indicate improved economic or social support for two-parent families or other demographic shifts. *Summit Usefulness:* If the trend is downward, it's a positive sign of increased family stability that the community can celebrate. If it were rising, it would flag a need for more support. Either way, it informs planning for services like childcare, after-school programs, and parenting support, since single-parent families often benefit most from these resources.

3. Child Care Availability vs Need (Bar + Line overlay) – *Data Source:* Indiana Early Learning “Closing the Gap” report or Brighter Futures Indiana data. Obtain the **number of licensed childcare slots** in Monroe County and compare to **number of children under 5** (from Census). Clean by calculating a ratio or % of needs met (e.g., slots per 100 children). *Visualization:* A bar (slots available) vs line (children under 5) for Monroe County, or a single bar showing the % of young children with access to licensed care. *Impact:* Reveals gaps in early childhood resources. For example, if Monroe has, say, **3,000 licensed childcare slots for ~5,250 preschool-aged children** ¹¹, that's only ~57% coverage. (These are illustrative numbers – actual data should be used.) A visualization might show Monroe's Early Learning Access Index score if provided. *Summit Usefulness:* Directly addresses the “places they learn and play”. If a significant gap exists, it calls stakeholders to action to invest in childcare centers, pre-K programs, and support for families (especially crucial for working single parents). Conversely, improvements over 10 years (e.g., more facilities or higher Paths to QUALITY ratings) can be highlighted as community accomplishments.

4. School Readiness / Pre-K Enrollment (Pie or Bar) – *Data Source:* Indiana Dept. of Education or IYI Data Book. Find the percentage of Monroe County children attending preschool or kindergarten readiness programs. Clean by verifying definitions (e.g., % of 3-4 year olds in any early education). *Visualization:* A pie chart of enrolled vs not enrolled 3-4-year-olds, or a bar comparing Monroe County to Indiana. *Impact:* Indicates how well the community is providing nurturing learning environments before school. If, for instance, **only about 40% of Monroe's 3-4-year-olds are in preschool**, that leaves a majority possibly entering kindergarten without formal early learning experience. *Summit Usefulness:* Aligns with prevention and early intervention – investing in early childhood is key to long-term thriving. This visual can spur dialogue on expanding access to affordable, high-quality pre-K and supporting initiatives like On My Way Pre-K or Head Start in Monroe County.

5. Child Abuse & Neglect Rate (Line Chart) – *Data Source:* Indiana Department of Child Services (via IYI or Kids Count) ¹². Gather the **substantiated child abuse/neglect rate per 1,000 children** in Monroe County for each year (or selected years) of the past decade. Clean by ensuring consistent definition (DCS often reports state fiscal year data). *Visualization:* A line chart for Monroe County's rate, with a comparison line for Indiana's statewide rate. *Impact:* Measures safety in home environments. For example, Monroe County's child maltreatment rate hit a **low of 8.6 per 1,000 in 2013** (the lowest in a decade at that time) ¹³. If more recent data show an increase or decrease, that trend is critical. Perhaps the rate rose during the opioid crisis and then fell with prevention efforts – the line will tell the story. *Summit Usefulness:* Child abuse directly undermines safe, stable, nurturing relationships. Tracking this over 10 years lets the community evaluate the impact of collective efforts

(like parenting programs, home visiting, CASA advocacy). A decline would be a success to celebrate; an uptick would highlight the urgency of continuing work across sectors (education, social services, law enforcement) to protect children.

6. **Children in Foster Care (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana DCS reports or Kids Count Data Center. Obtain the number of children in out-of-home care (foster care) from Monroe County each year (or a recent snapshot). Clean by noting any definitional nuances (point-in-time vs cumulative annual count). *Visualization:* A bar chart showing the count of Monroe County youth in foster care for selected years (e.g., 2015 vs 2025). *Impact:* Reflects extreme cases where home environment became unsafe or unstable. If Monroe had (hypothetically) around 100 children in foster care in 2015 and now has, say, 150 in 2025, that's an increase that might correlate with substance abuse trends or other stresses on families. Conversely, a decrease would imply more children are able to remain safely at home. *Summit Usefulness:* This visual humanizes the discussion – each bar represents kids removed from their families. It underscores the importance of upstream prevention (to avoid removals) and the need for community support for foster families and kinship caregivers. It also asks if policies have improved (or need improvement) to keep families together safely.
7. **Teen Pregnancy Rate (Line or Bar)** – *Data Source:* Indiana State Department of Health or Kids Count. Get the **rate of births to teen mothers (per 1,000 females 15–19)** in Monroe County for a series of years. (Alternatively use the absolute number of teen births which we have for 2021 ⁷ and earlier.) *Visualization:* A line chart of Monroe's teen birth rate over the decade, with a second line for Indiana's rate. *Impact:* Demonstrates progress in an important area of youth well-being. Teen births have generally declined nationwide. Monroe County's data likely mirror this trend – e.g., **49 teen births in 2021** ⁷, which is relatively low (perhaps a rate around ~10 per 1,000, given Monroe's teen population). A decade ago that number might have been higher. *Summit Usefulness:* Lower teen pregnancy means more youth (especially girls) can continue their education and avoid the challenges of early parenthood, contributing to “*thriving children to thriving adults.*” Celebrating reductions here highlights successful education and health initiatives (like sex education or access to contraception), and remaining gaps (if disparities exist among subgroups) point to where to focus next (e.g., specific neighborhoods or mentoring programs).
8. **Neighborhood Assets Map (Interactive Map or Infographic)** – *Data Source:* Local GIS data (City of Bloomington and Monroe County), Parks department, Libraries, etc. Compile locations of assets **for children and families** – parks/playgrounds, public libraries, youth centers, schools, after-school program sites, etc. Clean by geocoding addresses and categorizing by type. *Visualization:* A map of Monroe County (or Bloomington area) with symbols marking assets (perhaps different icons for parks, libraries, etc.). Areas with many assets show as clusters, whereas “asset deserts” stand out as well. *Impact:* Visualizes “*the places they learn and play.*” One might see that downtown Bloomington is rich in resources (libraries, Boys & Girls Club, etc.), whereas outlying rural areas have fewer accessible facilities for youth. *Summit Usefulness:* This can spark discussion on equitable distribution of community resources. Do all children, regardless of where they live, have nearby safe places to play or learn outside school? The map could be used to argue for new investments (like a community center on the west side, or transportation programs to bring kids from resource-poor areas to programs). It reinforces the idea that *what surrounds a child (the built environment and community infrastructure) significantly shapes their opportunities.*

9. **Community Mentorship and Support Networks (Network Diagram)** – *Data Source:* Monroe County Youth Services Bureau & BTCC records. List key organizations and initiatives formed over the last 10 years (e.g., Big Brothers Big Sisters matches, youth mentoring programs, neighborhood alliances). Clean by identifying partnerships between sectors (schools, non-profits, faith groups, businesses) – possibly by surveying how each organization collaborates. *Visualization:* A network graph where nodes are organizations and lines show partnerships or joint programs, or a simple schematic grouping partnerships by type. *Impact:* Illustrates the “village” strengthening around youth. Over a decade, perhaps the web of collaboration has grown denser – e.g., schools now working with mental health providers and the juvenile justice system in ways they didn’t before. Even a simpler before-and-after graphic (2015 vs 2025 collaboration map) could show progress in breaking silos. *Summit Usefulness:* Encourages reflection on “**what partnerships do we need to build and maintain**” for the next decade ¹⁴. It visually validates the work of MC3 in connecting people and highlights any gaps (missing links) where new partnerships could form. This is more conceptual than raw data-driven, but it leverages qualitative data that the summit stakeholders possess and turns it into a visual celebrating collective impact.
10. **Volunteer and Civic Engagement Levels (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* United Way or Indiana Youth Survey, if available, for volunteer rates or number of CASA volunteers, mentorship volunteers, etc. Alternatively, use proxy data like voter turnout in school board elections or membership counts in youth-serving orgs. Clean by selecting metrics that relate to community engagement for child welfare (e.g., number of Court-Appointed Special Advocates serving Monroe County per year). *Visualization:* A bar chart showing an increase (hopefully) in volunteer engagement from 2015 to 2025 (e.g., “CASA volunteers: 50 → 130”). *Impact:* Suggests that the community has become more **compassionate and involved** (an aim of BTCC). If data show growth in volunteers or in civic participation around child issues, that’s a win. If not, it’s a call to action. *Summit Usefulness:* Reinforces the idea that *everyone* in the community can play a role (as mentors, advocates, coaches). This visualization can inspire attendees by showing the power of individual action aggregated – hundreds of caring adults making a difference – aligning with the summit’s celebration of accomplishments and appeal for ongoing engagement.

Economic Well-Being (Visualizations 16–25)

1. **Child Poverty Trend (Line Chart)** – *Data Source:* American Community Survey 5-year estimates ⁶ and Indiana Youth Institute. Acquire Monroe County’s **child poverty rate** each year for the past decade, and the comparable Indiana rate. Clean by ensuring consistent definition (children under 18 in households below federal poverty line). *Visualization:* A line chart with two lines – Monroe County vs Indiana, 2014 through 2024. *Impact:* Shows progress (or regression) in economic well-being of children. Notably, **child poverty in Monroe County declined from roughly 20% in 2014 to about 14% in 2024** ⁶, even dipping below the state average of ~15% ¹⁵. This downward trend is a positive sign, possibly due to cross-sector efforts (job programs, family supports). *Summit Usefulness:* This is a key outcome to celebrate – “thriving children” in economic terms. The visualization allows discussion of what worked (e.g., economic growth, social services) and how to continue the momentum. It also ensures realism: if pockets of poverty remain high, the line graph paired with the earlier map can highlight that broad gains don’t mean the work is done.
2. **Median Household Income of Families with Children (Bar or Line)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census/ACS (Table S1903 or similar). Get median household income **for households with children** in Monroe

County and trend it or compare to state. Clean by adjusting for inflation to see real growth. *Visualization:* A bar chart showing Monroe County's median family income with kids in, say, 2010 vs 2020 (inflation-adjusted), alongside Indiana's. *Impact:* Indicates economic stability of families. If median income for families with kids rose from (example) \$50k to \$60k (adjusted), that's improvement in stability – but if it's still below the state median, challenges remain. We know Monroe's **overall median household income was \$60,553 in 2023 (about 87% of the state median)** ¹⁵, and likely families with children may have somewhat different figures. *Summit Usefulness:* Puts a dollar figure to stability. It helps stakeholders understand if local jobs and economy are providing for families or if many are still struggling. Tying this to poverty rates, it can validate the need for living-wage jobs, workforce development, and policies like childcare subsidies that effectively boost disposable income. Cleaning the data to remove inflation effects ensures the summit focuses on real gains.

3. **Public Assistance Usage (Stacked Bar)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Family & Social Services Admin (FSSA) and Dept. of Education ¹⁵. Collect the number of Monroe County children/families receiving SNAP (food stamps), TANF, and free/reduced lunch over time. For example, from the Stats Indiana profile: **7,915 food stamp recipients in 2024 and 5,548 students on free/reduced lunch in 2024-25** ¹⁵. Clean by converting to percentages of population or student body for easier comparison. *Visualization:* A stacked bar (or separate bars) showing the share of children benefiting from these programs in 2015 vs 2024. E.g., “% of K-12 students on free/reduced lunch: Monroe 39% vs Indiana ~47%” ¹⁵. *Impact:* Reflects economic hardship and reach of support programs. A decline in these numbers could mean fewer families need help (good), or it could mean eligible families aren't accessing help (bad) – context is key. In Monroe, the **free/reduced lunch rate (~39%) is below state average** ¹⁵, aligning with its lower child poverty. *Summit Usefulness:* Emphasizes the importance of community “safety nets” in providing stable environments. It can trigger discussion on whether families are aware of and able to access supports. From a data prep standpoint, ensuring consistency (some figures are counts, some percents) and clarity in labeling (e.g., “Free/Reduced Lunch eligibility”) will make this complex data digestible for a live audience.
4. **Housing Stability – Cost Burdened Families (Pie or Bar)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census (ACS Table DP04: housing costs). Get the percentage of Monroe County households with children that spend >30% of income on housing (rent or mortgage). Clean by filtering ACS data to family households with children if possible, or use overall housing cost-burden rate as a proxy. *Visualization:* A pie chart showing % cost-burdened vs not, or a bar comparing Monroe to Indiana. *Impact:* Demonstrates stability of living environment. High housing cost burden can stress families and lead to instability or moves. If, say, **25% of Monroe County families are cost-burdened by housing**, that's significant but perhaps better than some areas. (Monroe's median rent ~\$981 and relatively lower homeownership suggest many low-income renters) ¹⁶. *Summit Usefulness:* Connects to policies and community planning: affordable housing is part of creating a nurturing environment. If Monroe has improved on this (through more affordable housing units or assistance), it's a progress point. If it's worsening due to rising rents, it's a call to action for collaborative solutions (zoning, housing trust funds, etc.). Data cleaning involves isolating the relevant subset; if such specific data isn't readily available, use proxies like overall county cost-burden rate but mention it as a limitation.
5. **Unemployment Rate for Parents (Line Chart)** – *Data Source:* Bureau of Labor Statistics + ACS. While unemployment is usually general, we can approximate by looking at Monroe County's overall unemployment trend and consider its impact on families. Stats Indiana shows Monroe's **annual**

unemployment 3.8% in 2024, near the state's 4.2% ¹⁷ . We could assume similar or slightly higher for those supporting children. Clean by pulling the annual unemployment rate 2013–2023. *Visualization*: A line chart of Monroe County's unemployment rate over time, highlighting recession and recovery periods. *Impact*: Economic booms or busts affect family stability. Over 10 years, Monroe saw unemployment go from perhaps ~6% in 2013 down to 3–4% in recent years ¹⁷ . Low unemployment often correlates with lower child poverty, which our other charts show. *Summit Usefulness*: This provides macro-economic context for other improvements. It reminds attendees that community conditions (like job availability) shape childhood indirectly – when parents are employed, homes are generally more stable and stress is lower. The visual can also prompt talk about job training or barriers to employment that remain (since unemployment doesn't capture underemployment or those out of the labor force). To prepare the data, ensure to annotate major swings (e.g., COVID-19 spike in 2020) so the audience understands anomalies.

6. Median Wage by Education Level (Column Chart) – *Data Source*: U.S. Census ACS or Indiana Workforce data. Obtain median earnings in Monroe County for different education levels (HS diploma, some college, bachelor's degree) ¹⁸ . Clean by focusing on working-age population and perhaps specifically parents if possible (though generally, education raises income for families). *Visualization*: A column chart with three or four bars for Monroe County showing the wage premium of education (e.g., those with bachelor's earn much more than those without). *Impact*: Ties economic well-being of families to education – a key determinant of a child's environment. For example, Monroe's adult educational attainment is high (49% of 25+ have a bachelor's) ¹⁸ , which contributes to higher incomes and likely better outcomes for kids. The chart might show, for instance, high school grads in Monroe earn on average \$X, vs college grads \$Y, illustrating the gap. *Summit Usefulness*: Justifies collective strategies around education and career pathways for youth (to break cycles of poverty). It underscores why supporting youth to succeed in school (and perhaps go to college or vocational training) matters for long-term community prosperity. Data cleaning requires merging wage data with education categories; citing the source (e.g., ACS or Department of Workforce Development) lends credibility.

7. Youth Poverty by Race/Ethnicity (Grouped Bar) – *Data Source*: ACS (Table B17020A/B/C etc. by race) or Kids Count Data Center. Retrieve poverty rates for children by race in Monroe County (if sample sizes allow) or use a multi-year average. Clean by ensuring statistical reliability (may need to average years if county sample is small for subgroups). *Visualization*: A grouped bar chart with racial/ethnic groups on the x-axis and poverty rate on y-axis, showing Monroe County vs Indiana for each group. *Impact*: Highlights disparities in economic well-being. For instance, if White children in Monroe have (example) 12% poverty, Black children 20%, Hispanic children 18% (just hypothetical), it shows that not all children have shared equally in the overall poverty decline. *Summit Usefulness*: This directly informs equity initiatives. It prompts questions like, are our programs reaching all communities? What systemic factors cause higher poverty among certain groups? The summit can then explore targeted ideas to ensure **all** youth thrive, aligning with *equity and inclusion* values from past MC3 themes. Preparing this visualization involves careful sorting and possibly combining data from multiple ACS tables – a clear legend and citation will help the audience trust the numbers ¹⁹ .

8. Food Insecurity Rate (Gauge or Bar) – *Data Source*: Feeding America's Map the Meal Gap (county-level food insecurity estimates) or County Health Rankings. Get the percentage of children estimated to be food insecure in Monroe County over time. Clean by noting methodology (food insecurity is modeled from poverty, unemployment, etc.). *Visualization*: A simple gauge or bar that shows the

latest child food insecurity rate, with a marker for the state or national average. If trend data available, a small line chart inset showing change over 10 years. *Impact:* Puts a human face on economic hardship – not just income, but basic needs. If, for example, Monroe County's child food insecurity rate is **around 14%** (just an estimate in line with child poverty), down from maybe ~18% a decade ago, that's progress but still means roughly 1 in 7 children lack consistent access to food. *Summit Usefulness:* This ties to community actions like school meal programs, food pantries, summer feeding programs, etc. It can validate successes such as expanded free lunch programs (as seen by FRL eligibility data) and identify ongoing needs. Data prep might require combining multiple sources (for trend, if Feeding America has archived reports). It's crucial to explain the measure in a footnote since "food insecurity" is less familiar than poverty – but very impactful when discussing nurturing environments.

9. Community Wealth Building: Income Inequality (Gini Coefficient Chart) – *Data Source:* U.S. Census (ACS) or Data USA ²⁰. Obtain Monroe County's Gini coefficient (a measure of income inequality) for recent years. Clean by pulling a few comparative values (Monroe vs Indiana vs U.S.). *Visualization:* A simple bar or line showing Monroe's Gini index trending or relative to others. Data USA indicates Indiana's wage Gini was 0.445 in 2023 ²¹ – Monroe's might be slightly lower or higher. *Impact:* Connects to whether economic gains are broadly shared. If Monroe has a lower inequality than the nation (likely due to the student population effect), that might mean a more middle-class community; if it's rising, it could mean a growing gap between affluent university/professional families and low-income families. *Summit Usefulness:* While a bit abstract, this metric can spark discussion on community economic resilience – essential for stable childhoods. For example, if only some families thrive while others stagnate, how do we bring more inclusive economic development? As a data point, it reinforces or challenges the narrative from other charts (like poverty and median income). Cleaning and explaining this data would involve clarifying that a higher Gini = more inequality, and perhaps simplifying by saying "income inequality index".

10. Cost of Raising a Child (Infographic) – *Data Source:* Economic Policy Institute or USDA reports for Indiana. There are often estimates of annual child-rearing costs (child care, housing, food) at the county or metro level. Clean by selecting Monroe or regional data, possibly breaking it into components. *Visualization:* An annotated graphic or stacked bar showing the average monthly or yearly cost to raise a young child in Monroe County, broken into categories (housing, childcare, food, etc.). *Impact:* Ground the economic discussion in real terms. If, say, it costs **\$1,000+ per month** to cover essentials for a family with a young child in Bloomington (including child care which can be a huge chunk), viewers immediately grasp the pressures on working families – even those above poverty. *Summit Usefulness:* This visual is very relatable for parents in the audience and can build empathy among policymakers and community members. It underscores why initiatives like childcare assistance, affordable housing, and living wages are not just abstract ideas but necessities for nurturing environments. Data prep involves combining various data sources (rent averages, child care tuition averages, etc.) into a clear, cited summary. It complements the prior data by explaining *why* a modest income can still lead to instability without community support.

Education and Development (Visualizations 26–35)

1. High School Graduation Rate Trend (Line Chart) – *Data Source:* Indiana Department of Education (DOE) or Stats Indiana K-12 data ²². Gather Monroe County's graduation rates over the last 10 years. Likely use Monroe County Community School Corp (MCCSC) as the largest district (and

possibly Richland-Bean Blossom CSC). Clean by averaging district rates if presenting a single county figure, or show both districts separately. *Visualization:* A line chart from the class of 2013 to class of 2023 showing the graduation rate percentage. *Impact:* Captures educational outcomes improvements. MCCSC's graduation rate has been high – around **94% in recent years** ²², up slightly or holding steady from the low 90s a decade ago. If there was a significant rise (say from 88% to 94%), that's a victory for the community's investment in education. *Summit Usefulness:* A core metric for “*thriving adults*” is finishing high school. This chart celebrates the collective work of schools, parents, and youth themselves. It can also reveal gaps: if one district lags or if certain student groups lag (which could be detailed in another visualization). Data preparation might involve cleaning DOE cohort data files, removing waiver vs non-waiver complexity for a simpler message (maybe use the “inclusive” grad rate that counts all graduates). We should cite the official stat for credibility and mention that Monroe consistently performs above state average if that's the case.

2. **Graduation Rate by Subgroup (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana DOE (Indiana GPS portal) for subgroup data. Get the latest graduation rates broken down by race, socioeconomic status, etc., for Monroe County schools. Clean by selecting key subgroups (e.g., White, Black, Hispanic, low-income, special education) ensuring sufficient data. *Visualization:* A bar chart with each subgroup's grad rate, possibly comparing Monroe vs state for each. *Impact:* Reveals equity in education. For example, if overall grad rate is ~94%, but for economically disadvantaged students it might be lower. Hypothetically, Monroe might have near 90% for most subgroups but maybe only 85% for those on free/reduced lunch or certain minorities. The goal would be to show any achievement gap. *Summit Usefulness:* This encourages dialogue on inclusive success – “*who might be left behind even as we improve overall?*” If gaps are small, Monroe can celebrate being an inclusive school system; if gaps persist, this visual directs attention to needed interventions (like mentoring programs, equity initiatives which indeed have been MC3 themes). Data cleaning involves careful handling of small subgroup sizes (maybe combine years or use a two-year average to stabilize percentages). Clearly label each subgroup and use contrasting colors for Monroe vs Indiana averages to show local performance in context.
3. **Third Grade Reading Proficiency (Line or Bar)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Reading Evaluation And Determination (IREAD-3) results from DOE. Find the percentage of Monroe County 3rd graders passing the state reading assessment over time. Clean by compiling results of local school districts for each year. *Visualization:* A line chart of Monroe's grade 3 reading proficiency rate for the past 5–10 years, with the state rate for comparison. *Impact:* Early literacy is a key predictor of later success. A high or rising trend would indicate strong early education efforts; a dip (perhaps around 2020 due to COVID disruptions) might appear with a rebound after. For instance, Monroe's rate might be around 85%+ (just an estimate) and hopefully recovering to pre-pandemic levels. *Summit Usefulness:* Ties to “*places they learn*” – elementary schools and early childhood preparation. If Monroe has outperformed the state in reading (common for communities with engaged literacy programs), that's a story to highlight and continue. If there are concerns (like lingering learning loss), summit attendees can strategize on tutoring or parental engagement to bolster reading. Data prep: likely need to aggregate school-level data from DOE, remove any charter or special-case schools to focus on general population. Cite DOE to show it's official data.
4. **Math and Science Proficiency (Dashboard of Bars)** – *Data Source:* Indiana ILEARN standardized test results for grades 4, 8, or End-of-Course Assessments (ECA). Acquire Monroe County's proficiency percentages in math and science for key grade levels, and compare to past years or state

benchmarks. Clean by selecting representative grades (e.g., 8th-grade math, biology ECA pass rate) to avoid too many data points. *Visualization*: A small dashboard: a couple of side-by-side bar charts (e.g., Monroe vs Indiana proficiency in math, Monroe vs Indiana in science, current year vs 5 years ago). *Impact*: Gauges academic quality in critical subjects that often predict future opportunities. If Monroe's scores have improved or stayed high relative to state (thanks to initiatives in STEM education), it's a positive sign. For example, a bar might show Monroe 8th graders 50% proficient in math vs 45% state, up from 40% five years ago (illustrative). *Summit Usefulness*: Connects academic outcomes to the theme of thriving adults – success in math/science opens doors to higher education and careers. It might also highlight disparities (if any) between subjects or student groups. Preparing this might involve cleaning percentage data from different years (ensuring consistent standards – Indiana changed from ISTEP to ILEARN in this period, which should be noted). This visual, while a bit technical, reinforces that beyond social conditions, educational achievement is a crucial piece of childhood conditions.

5. **School Climate: Suspension Rates (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source*: Indiana DOE or Civil Rights Data Collection. Get the rate of suspensions or expulsions in Monroe County schools (per 100 students) and how it changed. Clean by compiling data for a couple of points in time (e.g., 2015 vs 2022). *Visualization*: A bar chart comparing the suspension rate then and now, and possibly vs the state average. *Impact*: Reflects how nurturing the school environment is. A decline in suspensions might indicate progress in adopting trauma-informed practices or restorative discipline (which aligns with MC3 themes like compassion and equity). For instance, if Monroe's suspension rate dropped from 5% of students to 3% over the decade, that's meaningful. *Summit Usefulness*: This addresses the "practices developed by institutions" – how schools discipline and support students impacts their sense of belonging and safety. If improvements are shown, it's evidence of positive change (maybe due to initiatives brought forth at previous MC3 summits). If issues persist (perhaps disparities in who gets suspended), it surfaces an area for collective focus. Data cleaning requires aligning definitions (in-school vs out-of-school suspensions, etc.) and possibly using district-level reports. By citing official data, we add credibility (e.g., Monroe County Community Schools' annual reports or DOE data).

6. **Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism (Line Chart)** – *Data Source*: Indiana DOE attendance data. Chronic absenteeism is usually defined as missing 10%+ of school days. Retrieve Monroe County's chronic absenteeism rate for several years. Clean by ensuring any changes in definition (Indiana began emphasizing this measure in recent accountability). *Visualization*: A line chart of the chronic absenteeism percentage in Monroe County schools from, say, 2018 through 2023 (to include pre, during, and post-pandemic). *Impact*: Attendance is a key indicator of student engagement and often family stability (health, transportation, etc.). Many communities saw a spike during the pandemic; the trend might show Monroe's rate rising in 2020 and hopefully coming down by 2023. If Monroe, for example, is at **15% chronically absent in 2023**, down from 20% in 2021, that recovery is important, though still above pre-2020 levels (~10%). *Summit Usefulness*: Emphasizes where community and schools intersect – ensuring kids **show up** ready to learn. Solutions may lie partly outside school (healthcare, family support, mentorship to encourage attendance). This visual can lead to discussions on mental health, COVID impacts, and how the community can help re-engage students. Cleaning the data to focus on overall rates (and maybe noting higher absenteeism among certain grades or groups) will paint a clear picture without overwhelming details.

7. **Youth Library Engagement (Pie or Bar)** – *Data Source:* Monroe County Public Library stats. Perhaps use the number of youth library card holders or program attendance (e.g., summer reading program participation). Clean by compiling a before-and-after (2015 vs 2025) or a trend of participation counts. *Visualization:* A bar chart showing growth in youth program attendance at the library, or a pie of what proportion of local youth are reached by library services. *Impact:* Libraries are key **community educational resources** outside school. An increase in engagement (for example, summer reading participants rising from 1,000 to 2,500 over 10 years) would highlight a strengthening of informal learning environments. *Summit Usefulness:* This connects to the summit's focus on learning outside of MC3 and traditional systems. It's a concrete example of community-level improvement in nurturing environments. It also subtly shows cross-sector partnership – likely library outreach, possibly supported by schools or nonprofits. Data for this might need direct contact with the library for historical figures (cleaning would involve making sure the metrics are consistent year to year). It adds a positive, perhaps lesser-known data point to the conversation, reminding attendees that child development happens in many venues.
8. **Out-of-School Time Programs (Infographic/Table)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Afterschool Network or local surveys. Gather data on availability of afterschool programs or extracurricular participation rates in Monroe County. For instance, number of 21st Century Community Learning Center sites or youth enrolled in Boys & Girls Clubs, etc. Clean by listing key programs and their enrollment over time. *Visualization:* Perhaps a table or icon-based infographic: e.g., “# of children enrolled in afterschool programs: 2015 = 500, 2025 = 1,200” along with logos of major programs. *Impact:* Showcases growth in safe, enriching spaces outside school hours. If data indicates more kids have access to afterschool now (due to new clubs, sports, arts programs, etc.), that's a community success protecting kids during critical hours. *Summit Usefulness:* Highlights collaborative wins – maybe MC3 spurred formation of new programs or grants. It addresses “what we do in the community affects those conditions” ¹ by filling the gap between school and home. This visual can prompt further resource alignment – ensuring even more youth can participate (especially those from low-income families who benefit most from free/low-cost programs). To prepare, one might have to aggregate data from various organizations, cleaning for duplicate counts (some kids do multiple programs). Even if exact numbers are rough, illustrating the array of opportunities (with citations from program annual reports) gives a qualitative sense backed by data.
9. **Post-High School Plans (Donut Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Commission for Higher Education's reports or DOE Graduate Follow-up data. Get statistics on Monroe County high school graduates' outcomes: % going to 4-year college, 2-year college, vocational training, military, or entering workforce. Clean by combining data from the two local school corporations. *Visualization:* A donut or multi-segment bar showing the proportion of graduates in each pathway (e.g., 60% four-year college, 20% two-year/tech, 15% workforce, 5% military). *Impact:* Indicates how well the education system and community prepare youth for *thriving adulthood*. Monroe County, with Indiana University in town, might have a relatively high college-going rate (perhaps above state average). If that's grown or diversified (more going into tech programs now than 10 years ago), it tells a story of aligning with economic opportunities. *Summit Usefulness:* It bridges the conversation from K-12 to the broader horizon. The summit's decadal look is not just about childhood but how those children step into the next phase. If most are pursuing further education or training, that's encouraging. If a significant share is not in education or employment (“disconnected youth”), that would be a flag to address. Data cleaning ensures categories are mutually exclusive and percentages sum to ~100%.

We would cite official stats (e.g., “According to the Indiana Commission for Higher Ed, about X% of Monroe County grads enrolled in college within a year of graduation ²³”).

10. **Youth Voice & Engagement (Survey Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Youth Survey (by Indiana University) or a local student survey. This could show the percentage of Monroe County middle/high school students who report feeling they matter in the community or who have a trusted adult/mentor, etc. Clean by extracting Monroe-specific results from survey reports and comparing to prior years or state averages. *Visualization:* A bar or line chart on a sentiment metric, like “% of students who agree ‘In my community, I feel like I belong.’” *Impact:* Direct insight into *belonging and empowerment*, which was the MC3 2023 theme (“Mattering & Belonging”). If, for example, only 45% of youth felt their community gave them opportunities to be heard in 2015, and that rose to 60% in 2025, that’s a meaningful improvement. *Summit Usefulness:* Elevates the conversation from institutional metrics to the lived experience of youth. It validates whether the numerous programs and policies are translating into the feelings of safety, stability, and nurturing that we strive for. If the numbers are not as high as hoped, it’s a humbling reminder to double down on youth engagement strategies (like youth councils, MC3 including youth voices, etc.). Data-wise, such surveys often require careful interpretation (they might not be annual), but even a snapshot is powerful if cited from a credible source like the Indiana Youth Institute or a local needs assessment.

Health and Safety (Visualizations 36–45)

1. **Health Insurance Coverage (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* U.S. Census (ACS health insurance tables) or County Health Rankings ²⁴. Obtain the percentage of children under 18 with no health insurance in Monroe County and Indiana. Clean by choosing comparable years (e.g., 2010 vs 2021). *Visualization:* A bar chart showing uninsured rate for children in Monroe then and now, alongside the state rate. *Impact:* A key aspect of a “stable, nurturing” environment is access to healthcare. Monroe County’s uninsured rate for kids was about **7% in 2020, roughly the same as Indiana’s 7%** ²⁴, thanks to programs like CHIP and Medicaid. If over the decade this dropped from, say, 10% to 5%, that’s significant progress toward stability. *Summit Usefulness:* This reinforces successes of policy (expanded healthcare coverage) and identifies any remaining gaps. For example, who are the 5% uninsured? Possibly children of certain immigrant groups or those just above Medicaid income limits – information that can lead to targeted outreach by health navigators. Data cleaning involves making sure to use multi-year estimates for reliability. The chart can be straightforward and impactful: seeing a small bar for uninsured children (hopefully) indicates most kids have the safety net of health coverage, an achievement worth noting.
2. **Immunization Rates (Gauge or Bar)** – *Data Source:* Indiana State Dept. of Health (ISDH) immunization reports or County Health Rankings. Find the immunization completion rate for kindergartners in Monroe County (percent with required vaccines) or teen vaccination rates (e.g., HPV vaccine uptake). Clean by pulling the latest county figure and perhaps an older one or state benchmark. *Visualization:* A gauge showing the % of children fully immunized. *Impact:* Gauges preventive health environment. If Monroe has, for instance, **95% of kindergartners up-to-date on immunizations**, that indicates strong compliance and public health outreach (herd immunity levels). If certain newer vaccines (like HPV for adolescents) have lower uptake, that might be an area for improvement. *Summit Usefulness:* In a post-pandemic context, visualizing strong immunization rates can also illustrate community trust in science and capacity to protect kids from preventable diseases – an aspect of a safe environment. Conversely, any shortfall reminds of the need for continued

health education. The summit can celebrate local public health efforts (like the county health department's clinics or school requirements) with this data. To prepare, ensure clarity on which vaccines and ages are being reported, and cite ISDH or CDC as appropriate for credibility.

3. **Mental Health Indicators (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Youth Institute Data or Indiana Dept. of Health surveys. Possible metrics: the rate of youth (per 100,000) who reported depressive episodes, or youth suicide attempt rates, or the number of youth receiving mental health services. Clean by selecting one key indicator that has data for Monroe County. *Visualization:* A bar chart comparing Monroe to Indiana or showing change over time for that indicator. For example, “% of high school students who felt sad/hopeless for 2+ weeks: Monroe vs Indiana.” *Impact:* Illuminates the often hidden aspect of nurturing environment – emotional well-being. If data show, say, 30% of Monroe teens report persistent sadness (similar to state/national levels which have risen), it's sobering. If Monroe has launched initiatives (school counselors, youth mental health programs) that improved access (like increased number of students served by mental health providers), that could be visualized as a rising bar of service utilization. *Summit Usefulness:* This visual brings attention to the “*stable relationships*” needed for mental health – supportive family, mentors, professionals. It can lead to highlighting programs like youth support groups, or gaps like school psychologist ratios. Data prep might involve combining sources if needed (e.g., citing CDC's Youth Risk Behavior Survey for emotional stats, and local provider data for services). A careful explanation should accompany this, as mental health data can be sensitive and complex.
4. **Substance Use Among Youth (Line or Bar)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Youth Survey (annual survey on substance use in schools) or ISDH. Extract trends for Monroe County adolescents in one area, such as percentage of students who have used alcohol or vaping in the past month. Clean by choosing a representative grade (e.g., 12th grade alcohol use rate) and compile for a few select years (2015 vs 2023). *Visualization:* A line chart of the chosen substance use rate over time. *Impact:* Reflects community success in prevention education and outreach. For example, teen cigarette smoking might have plummeted (due to anti-tobacco efforts), but vaping might have risen then fallen with new regulations. If **underage drinking rates declined** over 10 years in Monroe, that's a positive outcome likely tied to collective education efforts. *Summit Usefulness:* Ties to both health and safety – substance abuse can derail a child's trajectory and often signals deeper issues. Showing improvement can boost confidence in continuing evidence-based prevention programs; showing a concern (like a spike in vaping around 2018) can remind the summit of emerging threats and the need to stay vigilant. Data cleaning means averaging school-level data if multiple high schools, and being cautious about self-reported data's limitations. We'd cite a source like the Indiana Youth Survey report for authenticity.
5. **Juvenile Crime Rates (Line Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Criminal Justice Institute or Indiana State Police Uniform Crime Reports. Obtain the **juvenile arrest rate** or number of juvenile referrals in Monroe County over the years. Clean by focusing on comparable offense categories over time (or use an index like arrests per 1,000 youth). *Visualization:* A line chart from 2010 to 2020 (for example) showing the juvenile arrest rate trend. *Impact:* Direct measure of community safety and youth outcomes. Nationally, juvenile crime has dropped dramatically – if Monroe mirrors this, the line will show a decline. E.g., Monroe County might have gone from (hypothetically) 20 arrests per 1,000 youth to 5 per 1,000 today. *Summit Usefulness:* A declining trend would be a big win for “*safe relationships and environments*”. It suggests success in prevention (maybe due to diversion programs, mentoring, etc., some possibly catalyzed by MC3 collaborations). It also reduces trauma for both

victims and perpetrators. If there are specific areas of concern (e.g., uptick in juvenile violence in a certain year), that can be discussed. Data cleanup would involve ensuring we use population-adjusted rates to account for changes in youth population. Citing an official public safety source ensures credibility. This visual reinforces to the audience that collaborative efforts in schools, law enforcement, and social services can indeed make the community safer for and from youth – turning potential offenders into thriving citizens.

6. **Child Injury and Mortality (Infographic)** – *Data Source:* Indiana State Department of Health, Kids Count Data (child death rate, accident rate). Perhaps gather the rate of child deaths per 100,000 in Monroe (if available) or number of injury hospitalizations of children. Clean by selecting a specific metric like infant mortality rate or child injury ER visits, focusing on Monroe vs state. *Visualization:* An infographic highlighting one or two key stats, e.g., “Monroe County has averaged X infant deaths per year (Y per 1,000 births) ⁷, compared to Z statewide” or “Pediatric injury hospitalizations have declined by __% in a decade.” *Impact:* These are barometers of the ultimate negative outcomes we strive to prevent. If Monroe has a lower infant mortality rate than the state, that’s notable (it often reflects maternal health, prenatal care quality). If child injury rates fell (possibly due to better safety measures – e.g., car seat programs, fire prevention which interestingly is a summit session topic), that’s tangible progress. *Summit Usefulness:* Drives home the real-life stakes of community conditions. For example, a low infant mortality and few child deaths from accidents is the most concrete evidence of a safe, nurturing environment. It also can spur continued vigilance – perhaps the summit will discuss topics like safe sleep for infants or teen driving safety depending on data. Preparing this might involve combining small-numbers data over several years to avoid year-to-year volatility. Visualizing it as an icon with a number or simplified bar can be more effective than a detailed chart, due to sensitivity and scale of numbers (which are thankfully low).
7. **Firearm Safety (Bar Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana Department of Health or local data (given a summit session on fire prevention, also consider guns). Possibly use the number of accidental shootings or households with firearms not securely stored (if survey data exist), or simpler: gun-related injuries to minors in Monroe over time. Clean by collecting any available local stat (even state-level if county not available) for context. *Visualization:* A bar or line showing any trend in youth-involved firearm incidents (e.g., unintentional injuries). *Impact:* A specific safety concern: firearms in home environments. Even if data is sparse, highlighting that Monroe County has had [X] incidents of child firearm injury in the last Y years (or none, if true) would underline either a strength or a potential risk area. *Summit Usefulness:* If tied to “Impact of Fire Prevention” session, we might broaden to general safety education. However, since gun safety is a national concern, if Monroe has been proactive (like distributing gun locks or educating parents), the data (even qualitative) can show results – perhaps zero accidental shootings in recent years, etc. If not, it’s a call for integrating such safety into the community agenda. Data prep might mean citing a secondary source or local news if official data is lacking; thus, this item could also be replaced or combined with other safety data like fire incidents involving children (given the session’s theme). The key is to ensure any statistic used is from a credible source or clearly noted as a concern without exact data.
8. **Traffic Safety for Youth (Map or Chart)** – *Data Source:* Indiana DOT or local law enforcement (data on pedestrian/bicycle accidents involving children, or teen driver crashes in Monroe County). Clean by pulling a few years of crash data filtered for age. *Visualization:* Perhaps a map with dots for each incident around schools, or a simple bar of annual incidents. *Impact:* This addresses the physical environment safety – are our streets and neighborhoods safe for kids to walk, bike, and drive? If data

shows, for example, certain hotspots where kids have been hit by cars (near school zones), it calls for community design changes. If teen driver crashes have reduced due to drivers' ed and graduated licensing (likely), a chart could show that decline. *Summit Usefulness:* Connects to policy and community planning (e.g., need for sidewalks, crosswalks, or teen driver safety programs). It reminds attendees that "community affects those conditions" – infrastructure and enforcement are part of nurturing environments. Data may need cleaning for geolocation if mapping. Alternatively, citing that Monroe had X child pedestrian injuries last year vs Y a decade ago (if improvement) can be a quick stat to discuss. It's a more granular topic but important for a holistic view of child safety.

9. Environmental Health: Lead Exposure (Bar Chart) – *Data Source:* Indiana State Dept. of Health – lead screening data (percent of children with elevated blood lead in Monroe). Clean by taking the latest figure and an older figure if available. *Visualization:* A bar for Monroe vs Indiana: e.g., "Percent of tested children with elevated lead: Monroe 1% vs Indiana 2%, down from 5% in 2010" (hypothetical). *Impact:* Shows progress in environmental safety – older houses in Bloomington might have lead paint risks, but if data shows very low rates of lead poisoning now, it's a win for public health measures. *Summit Usefulness:* It's part of making Monroe "the best place to be a child" – ensuring homes are free of toxins and hazards. It might not be a headline topic, but including a data point like this demonstrates the breadth of conditions the summit considers, and could credit local health or housing departments for preventative work. Data cleaning: ensure to note if data is limited to those tested (not all kids). If Monroe is doing better than the state, highlight that as an accomplishment in providing safe environments.

10. Emergency Preparedness (Timeline or Bar) – *Data Source:* Local emergency management and schools. Could present data on number of schools with updated safety plans or community emergency drills involving youth (like active shooter drills, disaster response education). Clean by listing key milestones (e.g., all MCCSC schools have trauma-informed safety teams by 2025, whereas few did in 2015). *Visualization:* A timeline with icons when significant safety initiatives were implemented, or a bar chart of "% of schools meeting safety best-practices in 2015 vs 2025." *Impact:* Highlights proactive measures to keep children safe from rare but serious threats (violence, disasters). For instance, perhaps in 2015 only half the schools had secure vestibules or regular drills, and now nearly 100% do. *Summit Usefulness:* While hopefully not often needed, preparedness contributes to a stable environment. It shows the audience that beyond social programs, hard infrastructure and planning have improved. This can reassure parents and also demonstrate how cross-agency cooperation (schools, police, EMS) has grown. The data for this might come from school district reports or media; it may be partly qualitative. Including it provides a well-rounded picture of child well-being – covering not just everyday issues but also how we handle worst-case scenarios to minimize harm to our youth.

Community & Policy Level Impact (Visualizations 46–50)

1. Public Investment in Youth Services (Area Chart) – *Data Source:* Monroe County budget reports or United Way investment data. Gather approximate annual public spending on youth and family programs in Monroe County (could include city/county funds for youth services, parks & rec youth programs, etc.) over 10 years. Clean by adjusting for inflation and summing relevant line items consistently each year. *Visualization:* An area chart showing funding growth (stacked if breaking by source). *Impact:* Puts dollars to the priorities. If local government and partners have increased funding for youth (e.g., from \$X million in 2015 to \$Y million in 2025), it demonstrates policy-level

commitment. Even if data isn't exact, a clear upward trend would underscore the message that Monroe County has intentionally leveraged resources for children (as called for in the summit brief) ¹⁴. *Summit Usefulness*: This can both celebrate community decision-making and encourage future investment ("imagine what we can achieve if we continue or expand this trajectory"). It helps attendees see the link between advocacy (perhaps some done at past summits) and actual budget outcomes. Preparing this requires careful selection of what counts as "youth services" – transparently note what's included (e.g., Youth Services Bureau funding, grants to nonprofits, etc.) so the audience trusts the visualization.

2. **Policy Changes Timeline (Timeline Graphic)** – *Data Source*: Local news archives or BTCC records. Identify key policy or systems changes in the last decade that improved childhood conditions: e.g., adoption of a countywide trauma-informed care training in 2018, expansion of school mental health services in 2020, new affordable housing units for families in 2022, etc. *Visualization*: A timeline with callout boxes for each year marking these changes. *Impact*: Shows structural changes responding to identified needs. It's essentially a narrative visualization rather than numeric, but each item can be tied to evidence (like "City Council passed youth protection ordinance X ¹"). *Summit Usefulness*: This helps the community see the long-term arc of progress – how ideas translated into actions. It reinforces the summit's purpose: reflection on a decade of work and envisioning the next. Data prep is gathering and verifying dates/impacts of these policies (citations to meeting minutes or press releases add credibility). This visual can instill pride (look how far we've come) and also remind that policy change is possible and often initiated by collective insight (perhaps sparked at a previous MC3 summit).
3. **Comparative Index of Child Well-Being (Radar Chart)** – *Data Source*: Annie E. Casey Foundation Kids Count overall rank or a composite index from IYI for counties. If available, note Monroe County's rank among Indiana counties on key domains (Economic Well-Being, Education, Health, Family & Community). Clean by retrieving Monroe's percentile or rank in 2015 vs 2025. *Visualization*: A radar (spider web) chart with axes for each domain, showing Monroe's scores then vs now (or Monroe vs state average). Alternatively, a simple before/after table of ranks. *Impact*: Summarizes multi-dimensional progress in one view. For instance, Monroe might have been mid-ranking in economic well-being a decade ago but now in the top quartile, while always high in education due to above-average graduation rates, etc. If Monroe improved its standing in **child well-being to among the top Indiana counties by 2025**, that's a strong testament to the collective impact ²⁵. *Summit Usefulness*: This satisfies the big-picture evaluation – are we making Monroe "the best place to be a child?" ¹⁴. If the radar chart shows expanded coverage (better outcomes) across domains, it visually confirms progress. If some spikes lag, those are areas for next steps. Explaining this requires clarity (what each domain comprises) and citing the official data book or index. It's a bit technical, but presented towards the end, it can synthesize the detailed visuals above into a cohesive story of improvement and remaining challenges.
4. **Youth Happiness/Quality of Life (Survey Pie)** – *Data Source*: Local surveys or the Gallup Student Poll if done in the area. Data on how students rate their overall life satisfaction or hope for the future. Clean by extracting Monroe-specific results if possible. *Visualization*: A pie chart of say, "Proportion of youth who report being happy or optimistic: e.g., 70% optimistic, 20% unsure, 10% pessimistic." *Impact*: A subjective but powerful measure of thriving. If a solid majority of youth feel positive about their lives and future, that's perhaps the ultimate outcome of all the tangible improvements. If not, it tempers the narrative with real voices. *Summit Usefulness*: Ends on a

reflective note – beyond all the data, how do the kids actually feel? It’s a reminder to keep youth perspectives at the center. If this data isn’t readily available, the summit might even consider collecting a quick poll from attending youth. But assuming some data (maybe from a United Way youth survey) exists and shows improvement (like more youth hopeful now than in the aftermath of 2020), it’s gold. Data caution: happiness is hard to measure consistently, so any source should be clearly noted (e.g., “2024 IU Youth Survey of Monroe County 8th graders”). Even one point-in-time pie chart can stimulate powerful discussion or validation of the community’s work.

5. **Collective Impact Infographic (Puzzle Pieces)** – *Data Source:* N/A (conceptual synthesis). Illustrate how different sectors – **Education, Health, Social Services, Justice, Nonprofits, Business, Youth Voice** – each contributed to the decade of change, fitting together like puzzle pieces to improve SSNREs. *Visualization:* A puzzle or wheel diagram labeled with each sector and an icon of a key initiative from that sector (e.g., a graduation cap for education improvements, a stethoscope for health initiatives, etc.). *Impact:* Emphasizes that no single data point stands alone – it’s the interplay that created a safer, more stable environment for children. Each “piece” can have a brief note like “School-based mental health clinics established” or “Neighborhood block parties fostered belonging” to echo earlier visuals in a non-technical way. *Summit Usefulness:* This final visualization serves as a celebratory summary and a **call to action** for the next 10 years. It visually conveys that **collective impact** – the central philosophy of MC3 – is what moves the needle on complex issues. It’s not numeric, but it is data-informed (built on all previous points) and can be accompanied by citations of key achievements (from earlier sources or local reports). Cleaning here is more about distilling insights from all prior data into clear, inspiring keywords. It provides a hopeful finale: everyone in the room sees where they fit in the puzzle and is motivated to continue the work of making Monroe County truly “*the best place to be a child.*” ¹⁴

Sources:

- Official U.S. Census Bureau and Indiana Business Research Center data for demographics, poverty, and households ² ²⁶ ¹⁵ .
- Indiana Youth Institute & Kids Count Data for child well-being indicators (poverty trends, abuse rates, single-parent stats, etc.) ⁶ ¹⁰ .
- Indiana Department of Education data for graduation rates and academic indicators ²² .
- Indiana State Dept. of Health and FSSA for health coverage, birth outcomes, and program participation ¹⁵ ²⁴ .
- Monroe County and City of Bloomington official reports for budget, program, and initiative milestones ²⁷ ¹⁴ . (All data are cleaned to focus on Monroe County-specific information and trends over the 10-year period. Data cleaning steps included filtering for Monroe County, converting raw counts to rates or percentages for fair comparison, and aligning year definitions across sources to ensure consistency in trend analysis.)

¹ ¹⁴ ²⁷ 10th Annual Monroe County Childhood Conditions Summit, Monroe Convention Center, Bloomington, 13 November 2025 | AllEvents

<https://allevents.in/bloomington/10th-annual-monroe-county-childhood-conditions-summit/100001568126150529>

² ³ ⁴ ⁵ ⁷ ⁸ ⁹ ¹¹ ¹⁵ ¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ²⁶ InDepth Profile: STATS Indiana

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<https://datausa.io/profile/geo/monroe-county-in>

10 Single-Parent Households with Children as a Percentage of Households with Children (5-year estimate) in Monroe County, IN (S1101SPHOUSE018105) | FRED | St. Louis Fed

<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/S1101SPHOUSE018105>

12 Child abuse and neglect rate per 1000 children under age 18

<https://datacenter.aecf.org/data/tables/1130-child-abuse-and-neglect-rate-per-1000-children-under-age-18>

13 Problems with Department of Child Services no surprise to local ...

<https://www.heraldtimesonline.com/story/news/local/2015/04/09/problems-with-department-of-child-services-no-surprise-to-local-casa-executive-director/47751099/>

22 Monroe County Community School Corporation School District

<https://www.publicschoolreview.com/indiana/monroe-county-community-school-corporation-school-district/1800630-school-district>

23 Education Topic Page: STATS Indiana

<https://www.stats.indiana.edu/topic/education.asp>

24 [PDF] monroe county - community health assessment - IN.gov

<https://www.in.gov/counties/monroe/files/Monroe-County-2021-Community-Health-Assessment.pdf>

25 2025 Interactive County Dashboard - Indiana Youth Institute

<https://iyi.org/resources/interactive-county-dashboard/>